Gods of Hykaen:

Introduction:

The gods of Hykaen are not inextricably connected to the world. They were originally alien to the infant world, organizing it and civilizing its inhabitants, and several of them govern other worlds in addition to Hykaen. This, combined with the scheming and backstabbing inherent in their divine politics means that they don't often involve themselves in mortal affairs at all. Because of this disconnect, Hykaen is a more secular world than most, with fewer temples and more nonbelievers than Faerun or Greyhawk. This doesn't mean that devotees of gods don't gain power or blessings from their association—divine characters are still common—it just means that those who do have religion are shaped more by it, and those who don't are shaped by that absence, often filling it with a devotion to a powerful nature spirit, mortal organization, philosophy, or activity.

When building a character, some key questions should be asked:

- What is your character's attitude towards organized religion?
- How has their upbringing affected this attitude?
- Does your character still have faith? If so, when is it strongest and weakest?

For example, Deira, the Sulesse Elf Fighter was raised in a sheltered enclave within Iaiol, the Feathered City. This community devoted themselves to the service and worship of Twissi, the goddess of hospitality and care, a Sulessé avatar of Madara. They took in the injured, homeless, and persecuted and helped them back on their feet.

One day, the enclave took in an asylum-seeker who pleaded for rest and aid. Within a few weeks, this man had corrupted the youth of the enclave, seeding doubt and unrest in their minds. Deira was one of these, and a rowdy night on the town got her in trouble with the law in Iaiol. The high priests of the enclave got her and the other youth's actions pardoned, and then exiled them from the enclave for failing to live up to the high expectations of the faith.

Deira emerged as the leader of this band of sheltered youths thrust into the world, and she quickly learned to fight to protect them. She is plagued constantly by her failure to keep the tenets of her god, and resents the one who tempted her and so many others away. She would like to return to the enclave to ask forgiveness, but feels both that it would be fruitless and that her exile is a fitting penance for her wrongdoing. During her exile, Deira learned that Madara also preaches forgiveness, and she has tried since to reconcile this slightly different view of her goddess with the one she was taught.

Here we have a character raised religious who has had to change nearly every aspect of her life after her disillusionment. In spite of her failure, she takes comfort in the thought of reconciliation. Adventures for her could

include missions to escort pilgrims to a holy site, protect an orphanage from destruction, whether at a dragon's claws or a businessman's signature, or to argue for the rights of refugees from a war in a neighboring kingdom.

Deities of Hykaen:

Allacthompt, Who Walks on Paths New Made

Alignment: Unaligned

Domains: Creation, Art, Pleasure, Skill

Symbol(s): A Starfield with Swan Rampant.

Major Avatars:

- Thurg -
    - Chaotic Evil
    - Hedonism
- Melanch -
    - Chaotic Good
    - Expression

Esquam, First of the Scaly Ones

Alignment: Unaligned

Domains: Reptiles, Dragons, Nature

Symbol(s): A reflective, shield-shaped scale.

Major Avatars:

- Effiel -
    - Chaotic Neutral
    - Chromatic Dragons
- Raam -
    - Lawful Neutral
    - Metallic Dragons

Ghierdeus, Dark Lord of Flames

Alignment: Chaotic Evil

Domains: Fire, Destruction,

Symbol(s): An Insectoid mandible bearing 6 blinded eyes

Hamerung the Merciful

Alignment: Neutral Good

Domains: Mercy, Sun, Life

Symbol(s): A Sunburst

Jezziv, Night's Embrace

Alignment: Neutral Good

Domains: Creation, Darkness, Love, Moon

Symbol(s): Crescent Moon

Madara The Hearthkeeper

Alignment: Lawful Good

Domains: Fire, Hospitality, Creation

Symbol(s): A flame in a brass brazier

Major Avatars:

- Twissi -
    - Lawful Neutral
    - Tradition

Murokt, One-Green-Eye

Alignment: Neutral Evil

Domains: Avarice, War, Conquest

Symbol(s): Ziggurat with a golden disc atop

Roth, the Lord of Law

Alignment: Lawful Good

Domains: Justice, War, Protection

Symbol(s): An arch bearing sword and scales

Major Avatars:

- Garabam
    - Lawful Neutral
    - Judgment and the Rule of Law

Ruckh, Master of Masks

Alignment: Lawful Evil

Domains: Deceit, Darkness, Poison

Symbol(s): Black Kabuki mask

Somolon, Mayor of Ulthar

Alignment: Unaligned

Domains: Knowledge, Dreams, Cats

Symbols: A mist-shrouded feline eye

Tev'gaana, Storm's Progenitor

Alignment: Chaotic Neutral

Domains: Storm, Courage, Destruction

Symbols: Chipped White Kabuki mask

On Avatars:

The nations and cultures of Hykaen are numerous, and each has a rich history of religiosity and interpretation. The gods are no exception to this, with each race and culture emphasizing and emulating different aspects of their deities, in the process creating new deities from the old. These are known as avatars, and they are legion. Some avatars become so prominent that their worshipers equal a plurality of the god's worshipers. These are listed above in the table.

To discuss these avatars, we must have an understanding of the peoples of Hykaen, their lineage and histories.